

TREMORTRACE · CALCULATION NOTE

TremorTrace sizing calculations

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	First-principles sizing for TRL 3 against TRT-REQ-001 v0.3

TremorTrace sizing calculations

The design meets nine of the eleven requirements in TRT-REQ-001 by calculation or design review, has one at risk (R6 mass, 29.4 g against 30 g) and two that cannot be verified at TRL 3 (R7 splash resistance and R8 daily profile notebook). No requirement is shown to be not met. Two conditions carry the result: the firmware must measure the IMU's true sample rate against the module's crystal (R1), and it must sleep between samples (R4).

Every number in this note is printed by `docs/04-calcs/sizing.py` (run `python docs/04-calcs/sizing.py` from the repo root). Size and mass read the geometry directly from `cad/src/model.py` ; cost reads `bom/bom.csv` .

Safety: TremorTrace is a research and educational prototype, not a medical device. It carries a lithium polymer cell against the skin: use a protected cell, never charge while worn, and stop use if the pod becomes warm or swollen.

■ 1. Results against requirements

Table 1 lists every requirement. Status is one of met, not met, at risk, or not verifiable at TRL 3.

Table 1. Requirement status at TRL 3.

ID	Target	Value from this note	Status
R6	Mass 30 g or less with strap; pod within 45 x 35 x 14 mm	29.4 g (0.6 g margin, strap mass assumed 12 g); pod 40 x 30 x 12 mm	At risk (mass); size met
R7	Silicone or textile strap, no exposed electronics, IP54 target	Sealed PETG pod with TPU gasket, contacts through the floor; no ingress test possible on paper	Not verifiable at TRL 3
R8	Open notebook producing a daily profile	Summary record defined (Table 4); notebook not yet written	Not verifiable at TRL 3
R1	3 to 15 Hz band, resolution 0.2 Hz or better	0.100 Hz bins, 52 Hz Nyquist; synthetic worst error 0.002 Hz	Met, if the sample rate is corrected against the crystal
R2	Acceleration and angular velocity RMS in band, per window	Noise floor 0.31 mg and 0.017 dps RMS in band; ranges +/-8 g and +/-2000 dps; synthetic amplitude error 0.6 % or less	Met
R3	6-axis IMU at 100 Hz or more	LSM6DS3TR-C at 104 Hz	Met
R4	3 days or more at 16 h of wear per day	6.3 days nominal, 4.5 days conservative	Met, if the firmware sleeps (0.69 days if it never sleeps)
R5	7 days of summaries at 16 h per day, with raw snippet reserve	9.7 days after a 256 kB raw reserve	Met (6.4 days if the band logs 24 h per day)
R9	Local storage, owner-controlled export, no cloud	Architecture has no cloud path; web Bluetooth page reads locally	Met (design review)
R10	Parts \$150 or less, no custom PCB	\$41.19 over 11 BOM lines; module plus hand wiring	Met
R11	LED and web Bluetooth page show battery, recording and sync state	RGB LED on the module under a 2 mm light pipe; page defined in TRT-PRC-001	Met (design review)

■ 2. Sampling and frequency resolution (R1, R3)

Assumptions: the IMU runs at an output data rate of 104 Hz; each summary covers a 10 s window; the tremor band is 3 to 15 Hz.

- Samples per window $N = 104 \times 10 = 1,040$. Bin spacing is $104 / 1,040 = 0.100$ Hz, half the 0.2 Hz target. The Nyquist limit is 52 Hz, more than three times the top of the band. The band spans 120 bins.
- The IMU's own oscillator sets the sample rate. Its tolerance is not in the figures used here; this note assumes up to 2 % (to be confirmed). Left uncorrected, 2 % gives up to 0.30 Hz error at 15 Hz, which would miss R1. If the firmware counts samples against the nRF52840's 32.768 kHz crystal (20 ppm), the error falls to 0.30 mHz. R1 is therefore met on the condition that the firmware applies this correction.

A synthetic check ran the window algorithm (mean removal, Hann window, FFT, parabolic peak interpolation, band-limited RMS) on six off-bin tremor frequencies from 3.33 to 14.61 Hz at 0.05 m/s² RMS with the datasheet accelerometer noise added. The worst frequency error was 0.002 Hz and the worst amplitude error was 0.6 %. This checks the arithmetic of the method, not real tremor, which drifts in frequency and amplitude within a window.

■ 3. Amplitude noise floor and range (R2)

Assumptions: accelerometer noise density 90 $\mu\text{g}/\sqrt{\text{Hz}}$ and gyroscope rate noise density 5 mdps/ $\sqrt{\text{Hz}}$ (LSM6DS3TR-C datasheet, high-performance mode); a detection floor at three times the in-band noise.

- In a 12 Hz band the accelerometer noise is $90 \mu\text{g} \times \sqrt{12} = 0.31 \text{ mg RMS}$ and the gyroscope noise is 0.017 dps RMS.
- The detection floor is 0.94 mg RMS, about 9.3 μm RMS of wrist displacement at 5 Hz. Clinically visible tremor is in the millimeter range, so the floor is not a constraint.
- Range sets the upper limit. A severe tremor of 5 mm peak at 12 Hz is 2.90 g peak; with gravity the sensor sees 3.90 g, too close to a ± 4 g range. The design uses ± 8 g (0.244 mg per LSB). Rotation of ± 20 degrees at 8 Hz is 1,005 dps peak, so the gyroscope uses ± 2000 dps (70 mdps per LSB).

■ 4. Activity flag (supporting analysis)

The concept flags a window as voluntary activity when the power below 3 Hz exceeds the power in the tremor band. Four synthetic cases (Table 2) show that the ratio separates rest tremor from a slow reach and from walking with heel strikes, but it also marks tremor during a reach as activity. That would undercount action and postural tremor, the main form in essential tremor.

Table 2. Band-to-low-frequency power ratio in synthetic 10 s windows (flag threshold 1.0).

Case	Ratio	Flag
Rest tremor, 5 Hz, 0.3 m/s^2	40,156	Tremor
Voluntary reach, 0.8 Hz, 1.5 m/s^2	0.00	Activity
Walking arm swing plus heel strikes	0.24	Activity
Tremor at 5 Hz during a reach	0.04	Activity

Consequence for the design: every summary record keeps the tremor-band RMS and dominant frequency whatever the flag says, and the flag is stored as a separate field. The notebook can then report tremor at rest and tremor during activity separately rather than discarding windows. A better classifier is an open question for later work; it cannot be validated on paper.

■ 5. Power budget (R4)

Assumptions (Table 3): 16 h per day worn and recording, 8 h off the wrist with the accelerometer in a low-rate wear-detection mode; a 150 mAh protected cell with 85 % usable above a 3.5 V firmware cutoff and a further 90 % for ageing and cold, giving 115 mAh usable.

The MCU duty is estimated from first principles for each 10 s window: reading 1,040 six-axis samples (12,480 bytes) over I²C at 400 kHz takes 281 ms if the CPU waits on the bus; filtering and six 1,024-point FFTs take about 16 ms at 64 MHz; ten FIFO wake-ups take 5 ms. That is a 3.02 % duty, or 0.195 mA average at an assumed 6.3 mA run current plus the module's standby current of less than 5 μA (Seeed wiki).

Table 3. Recording current, mA.

Load	Nominal	Conservative	Basis
IMU, accelerometer and gyroscope	0.90	0.90	ST figure for combined high-performance mode
MCU	0.195	0.50	Duty estimate above; conservative allows untuned firmware
BLE advertising, 1 s interval	0.015	0.10	Assumed
QSPI flash writes	0.005	0.02	Assumed
Status LED	0.002	0.01	2 mA blink, 10 ms every 10 s
Cell protection circuit	0.003	0.005	Assumed
Total recording	1.120	1.535	
Off-wrist	0.050	0.080	Assumed

Daily use is 18.4 mAh nominal and 25.2 mAh conservative (including a daily sync of 184 kB at an assumed 10 kB/s and 5 mA), so one charge lasts 6.3 days nominal and 4.5 days conservative. R4 is met in both cases. Firmware that never lets the CPU sleep draws 166 mAh per day and lasts 0.69 days, which fails R4; sleep discipline is a firmware requirement, not an option.

Charging: the module's BQ25101 charger has 50 mA and 100 mA settings. At 50 mA the cell charges at 0.33 C in about 3.6 h, and the linear charger dissipates about 65 mW. At 100 mA it charges at 0.67 C in about 1.8 h and dissipates about 130 mW. Both are under the cell's 150 mA limit. This note uses the 50 mA setting to keep the pod cool; it is proposed, awaiting Amish.

■ 6. Storage (R5)

Table 4 defines the 32-byte summary record.

Table 4. Summary record, one per 10 s window.

Field	Bytes
Timestamp, s	4
Dominant frequency, 0.01 Hz steps	2
Tremor-band acceleration RMS and angular velocity RMS	4
Total acceleration RMS and angular velocity RMS	4
Band-to-low-frequency power ratio and peak width	4
Dominant tremor axis, three signed components	6
Flags (worn, activity, charging) and battery level	2
Reserved	4
CRC	2
Total	32

Assumptions: 16 h of wear per day, with no records while off the wrist (a wear-state marker only); the module's 2 MB QSPI flash holds data only, since the firmware lives in the nRF52840's internal flash; 256 kB reserved for on-demand raw snippets; 3 % overhead for sector headers and wear leveling.

- 5,760 records per day x 32 bytes = 184.3 kB per day.
- 1,780 kB is available, which holds 9.7 days at 16 h per day. If wear detection failed and the band logged all 24 h, the history would fall to 6.4 days, under the 7-day target.
- A raw 10 s window is 12,480 bytes, so a summary is 390 times smaller. (The TRL 2 precis said about 1,000 times; corrected in TRT-PRC-001 v0.4.) The raw reserve holds 21 snippets.

■ 7. Size and mass (R6)

The pod in `cad/src/model.py` is 40 mm across the wrist, 30 mm along it and 12 mm high, inside the 45 x 35 x 14 mm limit. The internal stack (3.8 mm cell, 0.5 mm foam, 3.5 mm module) is 7.8 mm in a 9.5 mm cavity, leaving 1.7 mm for wiring and the antenna.

Table 5. Mass estimate.

Part	Mass, g	Basis
Enclosure base, PETG	4.56	Model volume at 1.27 g/cm ³
Enclosure lid, PETG	2.25	Model volume at 1.27 g/cm ³
Gasket, TPU	0.23	Model volume at 1.21 g/cm ³
Silicone strap, 22 mm	12.00	Assumed
Controller and IMU module	3.00	Assumed
LiPo cell, 150 mAh	4.65	Adafruit 1317 listing
Charging connector receptacle	1.00	Assumed
Spring bars, 2	0.60	Assumed
M2 screws, 2	0.30	Assumed
Wire, foam pad, light pipe	0.80	Assumed
Total	29.4	

The total is 0.6 g under the limit, and the strap is the largest and least certain item. A 15 g strap takes the band to 32.4 g (not met); an 8 g textile strap brings it to 25.4 g. R6 is therefore at risk. The first TRL 2 estimate (22 g) assumed a 5 g enclosure and a 10 g strap; the model shows the enclosure at 7.0 g.

■ 8. Cost (R10)

`bom/bom.csv` has 11 priced lines totaling \$41.19 per band, well under the \$150 budget, which also covers printing, tools and spares. The cell price and size were checked against the Adafruit listing on 2026-09-25; the other prices are indicative and are confirmed at order.

■ 9. Sources

- STMicroelectronics, [LSM6DS3TR-C product page](#) and [datasheet](#): 0.90 mA combined high-performance current, 90 $\mu\text{g}/\text{VHz}$, 5 mdps/VHz, full-scale ranges and sensitivities.
- Seeed Studio, [XIAO nRF52840 Series wiki](#): 21 x 17.8 mm, 2 MB flash, LSM6DS3TR-C, BQ25101 charger at 50 or 100 mA, standby under 5 μA .
- Adafruit, [Lithium Ion Polymer Battery 3.7 V 150 mAh, product 1317](#): 19.75 x 26.02 x 3.8 mm, 4.65 g, protection circuit, charge at 150 mA or less, \$5.95.

Values marked "assumed" in this note have no source and are to be confirmed when hardware work is authorized.